

SIR OTONDE MICHAEL AWITI

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KENYATTA UNIVERSITY

EXAMINATION FOR THE DEGREE OF BACHELOR OF ARTS

UCU 111/103: CRITICAL THINKING AND PROBLEM SOLVING

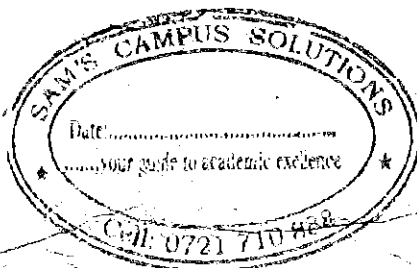
TIME: 2 HOURS

2ND SEMESTER 2023/2024

INSTRUCTIONS: Answer Question ONE and any other TWO Questions.

1. Discuss the role of critical thinking in self-examination. (20 marks)
2. Giving examples discuss John Mill's view that, "society that silences its critical voices undermines its own progress." (20 marks)
3. Giving examples, explain any five obstacles to problem solving. (20 marks)
4. Giving examples, explain how you can avoid being easily deceived. (20 marks)
5. Show how critical thinking can help individuals and society at large with situations like the recent Shakahole massacre (20 marks)

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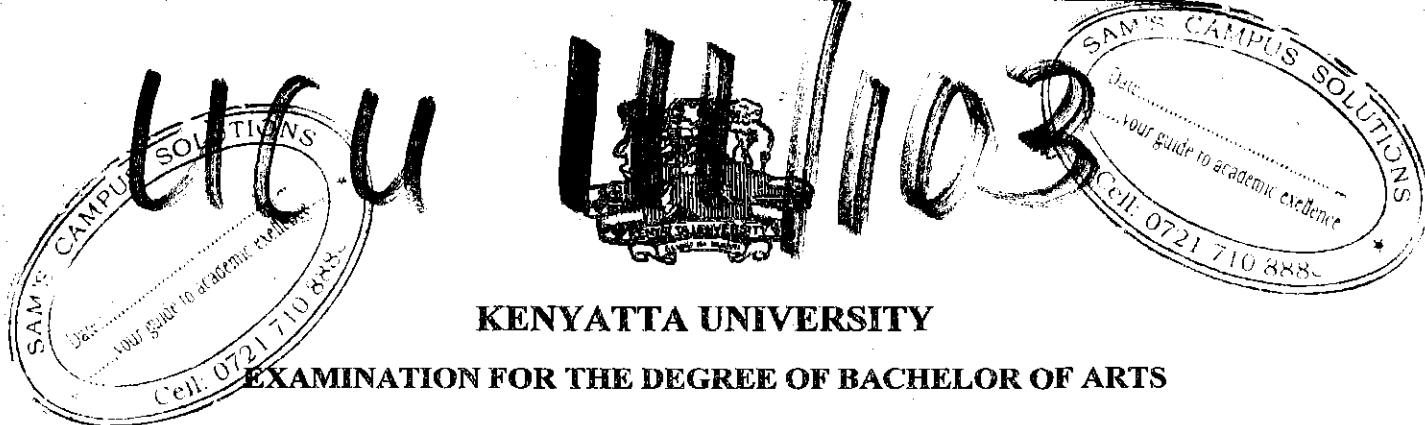
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UCU 111/103: CRITICAL THINKING AND PROBLEM SOLVING

1ST SEMESTER 2024/2025

TIME: 2 HOUR

INSTRUCTIONS: ANSWER ANY THREE QUESTIONS.

QUESTION ONE.

Describe conventional thinking and with examples, outline any four reasons why thinking at that level impedes societal progress. (20 marks)

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QUESTION TWO

Giving examples in contemporary Kenya, show how the following tools of reasoning can guide the citizenry in evaluating the suitability of the people aspiring for elective leadership positions. (20 marks)

- i. Intellectual honesty
- ii. Intellectual humility

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QUESTION THREE

Describe the link between decision making and problem solving and explain how critical thinking enhances our capacity for both. (20 marks)

QUESTION FOUR

With reference to Rene Descartes' meditations, and giving your own examples, show the importance of being skeptical in life. (20 marks)

QUESTION FIVE

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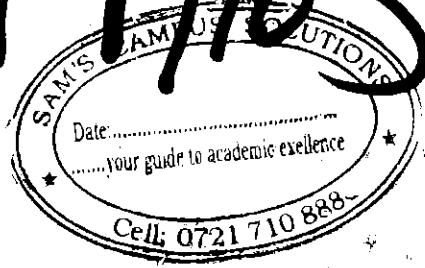
Giving examples, discuss the importance of self examination in contemporary society.

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(20 marks)

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UCU 111: CRITICAL THINKING AND PROBLEM SOLVING

1ST SEMESTER 2023/2024

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TIME: 2 HOURS

INSTRUCTIONS: ANSWER ANY THREE QUESTIONS.

1. Examine the view that critical thinking enhances performance in your academic life.

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(20 marks)

2. Discuss the importance of Socratic method to critical thinking and problem solving.

(20 marks)

3. By way of examples, discuss the six phases of decision making and problem solving.

(20 marks)

4. List and explain any five barriers to critical thinking and effective problem solving.

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(20 marks)

5. With reference to Descartes work on The Meditation on /First Philosophy, explain how through questioning and doubt, the mind of a thinker is transformed from a state of dependence to that of autonomy.

(20 marks)

6. Demonstrate how critical thinking is a necessary component of transformative education.

(20 marks)

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KENYATTA UNIVERSITY

EXAMINATION FOR THE DEGREE OF BACHELOR OF ARTS

UCD 103: INTRODUCTION TO CRITICAL AND CREATIVE THINKING

1ST SEMESTER, 2022/2023

TIME: 2 Hours

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INSTRUCTIONS: Answer question ONE and ANY other Two.

1. Giving examples, discuss the importance of critically and creativity in individual and societal transformation. (30 marks)
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2. Illustrating your answer with four appropriate examples, show how one can be deceived by fallacious reasoning.. (20 marks)
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3. Giving examples drawn from Rene Descartes' teaching in meditations show the importance of being an individualist thinker. (20 marks)
4. Providing examples from contemporary Kenya society, examine Plato's caution that we should take the verdict of senses with suspicion and skepticism. (20 marks)
5. Describe the Socratic Method and explain why it would be the most suitable foundation for quality education. (20 marks)

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EXAMINATION FOR THE DEGREE OF BACHELOR OF ARTS AND BACHELOR OF EDUCATION

UCU 111: CRITICAL THINKING AND PROBLEM SOLVING

1ST SEMESTER 2022/2023

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TIME: 2 HOURS

INSTRUCTIONS: ANSWER ANY THREE QUESTIONS

1. "Critical Thinking is instrumental in effective problem solving and decisive decision making". Using examples discuss this statement. [20 Marks]
2. Explain any FIVE intellectual traits and show how they enhance your problem solving capabilities. [20 Marks]
3. Using relevant examples discuss the importance of distinguishing appearance and reality for a university student. [20 Marks]
4. Discuss the importance of the Socratic dictum "an unexamined life is not worth living" for a critical thinker. [20 Marks]
5. Giving examples discuss ways in which personal freedom to think critically is beneficial to societal transformation. [20 Marks]

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UCU 103/111



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KENYATTA UNIVERSITY

**EXAMINATION FOR THE DEGREE OF BACHELOR OF ARTS
(FEBRUARY 2022 GROUP)**

UCU 103: INTRODUCTION TO CRITICAL AND CREATIVE THINKING

1ST SEMESTER 2021/2022

TIME: 2 HOURS

INSTRUCTIONS: Answer question ONE and any other two questions

- ✓ 1. "The catalyst to anarchy in any society is the retrogressive nature of the leadership". Discuss this statement with reference to the value and importance of critical and creative thinking. (30 marks)
- ✓ 2. Discuss the extent to which paternalism, peer influence, authority, religious fanaticism and culture are impediments to critical and creative thinking. (20 marks)
- ✓ 3. "Critical and creative thinking is a prerequisite to good decision making and problem solving". Discuss. (20 marks)
- ✓ 4. Examine the view that *Socratic Questioning Method* is a necessary condition to critical and creative thinking. (20 marks)
- ✓ 5. Using examples, discuss any five informal fallacies and indicate how they can be avoided. (20 marks)

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